

Audit Referral Quality by Source, Then Rebuild the Page

The play as run by **Gisele Navarro**, Managing Editor of HouseFresh, on the Unscripted SEO Podcast.

OBJECTIVE

Replace vendor claims about traffic quality with your own measurement, then change the product to match what you find. You end with a source-level read of how long visitors stay and how many pages they open, a written intent for each group of sources, and a page template plus a video format rebuilt around the shortest visit you actually get. Gisele's own read on HouseFresh: referrals from ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini stay about **two minutes**; referrals from Reddit and YouTube stay **six to eight** and open multiple pages.

KEY STEPS

1. **Stop reporting on rank for this audit and pull a source report instead.** *"So in general I don't look at tools. What I look at is the traffic on the site and their behavior."* The input is your analytics, not a visibility score you bought.
2. **Split referrers into three buckets before you look at a single number.** Answer engines (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, Copilot); community and social (Reddit, YouTube, X, Instagram, Facebook); everything search.
3. **Report two metrics per bucket: engaged time and pages per session.** The multi-page part separates a research visit from a check. *"people who come from ChatGPT, from Claude, from Gemini, they spend very little amount of time on the site - like around two minutes. And then people who come from Reddit, YouTube, they spend six to eight minutes on the site. And they will go to multiple pages."*
4. **Write one sentence of intent per bucket.** *"Whereas I feel like the traffic we're getting from LLMs is people that are coming maybe to check, but not necessarily to find. They already found, because the LLM told them."* A community referral arrives mid-research; an answer-engine referral arrives already holding the answer.
5. **Rebuild the top of the page for the shortest visit you measured.** *"So then the first two scrolls, they get everything that they need. And then if they want to go deeper, they can."*
6. **Apply the same rule to video.** *"Our videos are built so that in the first three to four minutes you got everything you need. And then you can stay and watch more and see more and find out more."*
7. **Keep the depth. Move it, do not cut it.** The long body earns the community referral in the first place. This is a reordering, not a trim.
8. **Ship it as a template edit, then re-measure against your own baseline after 30 days (inferred)** — never against a published benchmark.

CAUTIONARY NOTES

- **An industry claim is not a measurement of your site.** *"I have seen the claims that actually traffic from ChatGPT is more engaged and it performs better and it stays longer - and it doesn't match with what I see."*
- **Short does not mean worthless.** HouseFresh has not blocked the AI crawlers; being the source an answer engine leans on has value your session report will not show.
- **Attribution under-counts answer engines (inferred).** Some of it lands as direct or brand search. Read the trend, not the absolute.
- **Do not act on a bucket with a handful of sessions.** One good week is not a behaviour.
- **Not every surface you could rank on is worth owning.** She took images, social and Reddit, and refused one: *"I tried Quora. It's like a no man's land. It's not real... So I'm not going to waste my time here just because it's going to rank."* The rejection is the skill.
- **Own the surface rather than squatting on someone else's.** *"we opened the subreddit, so we are not going into other subreddits to answer questions."*

TIPS FOR EFFICIENCY

- **Save the segment, do not rebuild the report.** Build the three buckets once so this becomes a monthly five-minute read.
- **Start with one template, not the whole site.** The review or comparison template usually covers hundreds of URLs in one edit.
- **Test the top of the page by covering the rest of it** — on a phone, where two scrolls is far less than it sounds.
- **Pair the audit with a SERP surface pass.** List every surface you could still appear on when your own pages cannot.
- **Report the pages-per-session split first.** It is harder to argue with than time on page.

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